

Machine Round Instructions

1. A virtual machine running Ubuntu 24.04 will be assigned to you along with login details over the terminal.
2. Please use time before the test to ensure you can SSH into this VM and be prepared to start the process at the scheduled time sharp. Please let us know if you face any login issues before the coding begins.
3. There will be a brief orientation that is mandatory to attend. There will be some time for clearing your doubts. The coding round will begin shortly after that.
4. You will not have access to the internet. However, you will have all the reference material you wish to use.
5. We expect that your code is your own creation and that you know it like the back of your hand and explain why it works the way it does.
6. The virtual machine will have basic network debugging tools installed as well as compilers / interpreters for the following languages:
 - Python3
 - Java 11
 - C/C++
 - Golang 1.6
 - Ruby
 - Node.js

(if you wish to use other languages or find that you need a tool that is not installed, reach out to us as early as possible. We cannot guarantee that we will fulfill your request, but we will try.)

7. The server will have an introduction text file, called "welcome.txt", in the home directory that you can read. The actual question will be shared with you.

Tips and further notes:

1. Please use the SSH Cheat Sheet or your own knowledge to connect to the server provided in that email.
https://docs.google.com/document/d/1lQ5wWXf5ljFCtrD8-lLRQr2pcrLCHGKqVBWwQr68P_c/edit?usp=sharing
2. You will be expected to have logged in with SSH and execute "cat welcome.txt" successfully at least once before the round starts. This is to save time during the round so you are able to spend the entire time actually solving the question instead of dealing with connection issues.
3. The pre-round time will be a small intro where we will explain the rest of the round. This discussion is not for sharing hints or divulging answers or discussing with fellow candidates.

Once coding begins, only "**genuine technical difficulties**" will be sorted out here, for which a panel of Media.net members will be available.

4. You may be familiar with this test-case driven approach from online competitive coding sites. We will have similar test cases to test your code. You will have milestones in the question(s) that will help guide you.
5. Once you clear the first few milestones, you can ask for an evaluation by the Media.net panel (question notes will mention when to do this). We will use the same test executable against your code.
6. Once you have reached this point, it's not over -- continue coding! Panel members will drop in to check on you and ask you about your approach and help you with hints. We will be evaluating your approach, methods and solutions. Feel free to ask questions and keep interacting with the panel.
7. You may use your personal laptops for implementation, but you are expected to copypaste/transfer (say, with [scp](#)) the code to the VM for demonstration / testing / submission purposes.
8. You may drop out of the process at any time by informing and letting us know.